

School of Economic, Political and Policy Sciences

Public Policy (BS)

The Public Policy program is an interdisciplinary academic program, drawing upon the insights of Political Science, Economics, and other related fields, to help students to tackle the "*wicked problems*" in domestic public policy.

The Bachelor of Science in Public Policy is a degree program intended for individuals who will systematically analyze public policy issues, implementation, and analysis. Students will be prepared for entry-level analytical and administrative positions in a wide array of professional settings in the public, nonprofit, and private sectors.

Bachelor of Science in Public Policy

[Degree Requirements](#) (120 semester credit hours)¹

[View an Example of Degree Requirements by Semester](#)

Faculty

FACG> epps-public-policy-bs

Professors: Denise Paquette Boots, Patrick T. Brandt, Thomas L. Brunell, Euel W. Elliott, Jennifer S. Holmes, Dohyeong Kim, Clint W. Peinhardt, Richard K. Scotch, Marianne C. Stewart

Associate Professors: Jonas Bunte, Simon M. Fass, Banks P. Miller

Assistant Professors: Thomas Gray, Lauren Santoro

Professors Emeriti: Brian J. L. Berry, Paul Diehl, Lloyd J. Dumas, Donald A. Hicks, Murray J. Leaf

Associate Professor of Instruction: Karl K. Ho

I. Core Curriculum Requirements: 42 semester credit hours²

Communication: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Communication Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Mathematics: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Mathematics Core](#) courses (at or above the level of [MATH 1325](#) Applied Calculus I)

Life and Physical Sciences: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Life and Physical Sciences Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Language, Philosophy and Culture: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Language, Philosophy and Culture Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Creative Arts: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Creative Arts Core](#) courses (see advisor)

American History: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [American History Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Government/Political Science: 6 semester credit hours

[GOVT 2305](#) American National Government

[GOVT 2306](#) State and Local Government

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Government/Political Science Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Social and Behavioral Sciences: 3 semester credit hours

[ECON 2301](#) Principles of Macroeconomics^{3, 4}

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Social and Behavioral Sciences Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Component Area Option: 6 semester credit hours

[EPPS 2301](#) Research Design in the Social and Policy Sciences^{3, 4}

[EPPS 2302](#) Methods of Quantitative Analysis in the Social and Policy Sciences^{3, 4}

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Component Area Option Core](#) courses (see advisor)

II. Major Requirements: 54 semester credit hours

Major Preparatory Courses: 12-13 semester credit hours (0 semester credit hours beyond Core

Curriculum)

[MATH 1325](#) Applied Calculus I^{3, 4}_—

or [MATH 2413](#) Differential Calculus^{3, 4}_—

or [MATH 2417](#) Calculus I^{3, 4}_—

[ECON 2301](#) Principles of Macroeconomics^{3, 4}_—

[EPPS 2301](#) Research Design in the Social and Policy Sciences^{3, 4}_—

[EPPS 2302](#) Methods of Quantitative Analysis in the Social and Policy Sciences^{3, 4}_—

Major Core Courses: 30 semester credit hours

[ECON 2302](#) Principles of Microeconomics

[ECON 3310](#) Intermediate Microeconomic Theory

[ECON 3311](#) Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory

[GEOG 3304](#) Principles of Geospatial Information Sciences

[PSCI 3325](#) American Public Policy

[PSCI 3322](#) Constitutional Law

[PSCI 4343](#) Congress and Public Policy

[PSCI 3362](#) The American Political Institutions

[PPOL 4300](#) Capstone in Public Policy

[PPOL 4398](#) Internship⁵_—

or [PPOL 4V91](#) Undergraduate Research in Public Policy⁵_—

Public Policy Courses: 24 semester credit hours

Choose eight courses from the following:

[CRIM 4311](#) Crime and Justice Policy

[ECON 3315](#) Sports Economics

[ECON 3330](#) Economics of Health

[ECON 3336](#) Economics of Education

[ECON 4320](#) Public Sector Economics

[ECON 4336](#) Environmental Economic Theory and Policy

[ECON 4332](#) Energy and Natural Resources Economics

[GEOG 3377](#) Urban Planning and Policy

[GISCI 4384](#) Health and Environmental GIS

[IPEC 4301](#) Political Economy of Industrialized Countries

[IPEC 4305](#) Topics in Science, Technology and Institutions

[IPEC 4309](#) Urban Development

[IPEC 4310](#) Environmental and Health Policy in East Asia

[IPEC 4384](#) Health and Environmental Policy: A Global Perspective

[PSCI 3310](#) Managing Government Organizations

[PSCI 3326](#) Politics and Business

[PSCI 3323](#) American Federalism

[PSCI 4304](#) Energy and Environmental Politics and Policy

[PSCI 4305](#) Political Research

[PSCI 4307](#) Predicting Politics

[PSCI 4370](#) Policy Making Process

[SOC 4386](#) Health and Social Policy

[PPOL 4396](#) Topics in Public Policy⁶

[PPOL 4398](#) Internship⁵

[PPOL 4V91](#) Undergraduate Research in Public Policy⁵

[PPOL 4V96](#) Independent Study

[PPOL 4V99](#) Senior Honors in Public Policy

[PA 3380](#) Organizations: Theory and Behavior

[PA 4351](#) Managing the Urban Environment

[PA 3355](#) Introduction to the Nonprofit Sector

Other Classes as approved by Program Head

III. Elective Requirements: 24 semester credit hours⁷

Students must complete a minor within these elective hours

This requirement may be satisfied with lower- and upper-division courses from any field of study.

The plan must include sufficient upper-division courses to total 45 upper-division semester credit hours.

Minors

Students must take a minimum of 18 semester credit hours for the minor, 12 of which must be upper-division semester credit hours. Students who take a minor will be expected to meet the normal prerequisites in courses making up the minor, and should maintain a minimum GPA of 2.000 on a 4.00 scale (C average). Semester credit hours may not be used to satisfy both the major and minor requirements; however, free elective semester credit hours or major preparatory classes may be used to satisfy the minor.

Minor in Public Policy

21 semester credit hours

Required Courses: 12 semester credit hours

[GOVT 2305](#) American National Government

[GOVT 2306](#) State and Local Government

[ECON 2302](#) Principles of Microeconomics

[PSCI 3325](#) American Public Policy

Upper-Division Courses: 9 semester credit hours

Choose three courses from the following:

[IPEC 4301](#) Political Economy of Industrialized Countries

[IPEC 4305](#) Topics in Science, Technology and Institutions

[IPEC 4309](#) Urban Development

[IPEC 4384](#) Health and Environmental Policy: A Global Perspective

[PA 3380](#) Organizations: Theory and Behavior

[PA 4351](#) Managing the Urban Environment

[PA 3355](#) Introduction to the Nonprofit Sector

[PPOL 4301](#) Law, Science, and Policy

[PPOL 4302](#) Data and Policy

[PPOL 4303](#) The Internet and Public Policy

[PPOL 4396](#) Topics in Public Policy⁶

[PPOL 4398](#) Internship⁸

[PSCI 3310](#) Managing Government Organizations

[PSCI 3322](#) Constitutional Law

[PSCI 3326](#) Politics and Business

[PSCI 3362](#) The American Political Institutions

[PSCI 4304](#) Energy and Environmental Politics and Policy

[PSCI 4305](#) Political Research

[PSCI 4307](#) Predicting Politics

[PSCI 4343](#) Congress and Public Policy

Other classes as approved by program head

Minor in Science, Technology, and Policy

18 semester credit hours

Required Courses: 9 semester credit hours

[GOVT 2305](#) American National Government

[PSCI 3325](#) American Public Policy

[PPOL 4301](#) Law, Science, and Policy⁹

or [IPEC 4305](#) Topics in Science, Technology and Institutions⁹

Elective Courses: 9 semester credit hours

Choose 3 courses from the following:

[IPEC 4305](#) Topics in Science, Technology and Institutions⁹

[IPEC 4384](#) Health and Environmental Policy: A Global Perspective

[PPOL 4301](#) Law, Science, and Policy⁹

[PPOL 4302](#) Data and Policy

[PPOL 4303](#) The Internet and Public Policy

[PPOL 4396](#) Topics in Public Policy

[PSCI 4304](#) Energy and Environmental Politics and Policy

[PSCI 4356](#) International Political Economy

1. Incoming freshmen must enroll and complete requirements of UNIV 1010 and the corresponding school-related freshman seminar course. Students, including transfer students, who complete their core curriculum at UT Dallas must take UNIV 2020.
2. Curriculum Requirements can be fulfilled by other approved courses from institutions of higher education. The courses listed are recommended as the most efficient way to satisfy both Core Curriculum and Major Requirements at UT Dallas.
3. A Major requirement that also fulfills a Core Curriculum requirement. Semester credit hours are counted in Core Curriculum.
4. Prerequisite course to upper-division courses.
5. Course can be taken as a Prescribed Elective if not used as a Major Core.
6. Course can be repeated for credit.
7. At least 6 semester credit hours must come from upper-division courses.
8. PPOL 4398 can be used for Public Policy minor if it has not been used as part of the Major Core.

9. May be used to fulfill the Elective Courses requirement of the Science, Technology, and Policy minor if not used in the Required Courses component.

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